

2004-11

rec'd 3/15/04

SPECIES: RUBY THROATED HUMMINGBIRD | ARCHILOCHUS COLUBRIS
 (Vernacular Name) (Scientific Name)

DATE(S): 7/31/03 TIME OF OBSERVATION: 1:30 PM TO 2:30 PM

EXACT LOCATION: ALLEY-WAY NORTH OF POST OFFICE IN WELDONA

NEAREST TOWN: WELDONA COUNTY: MORGAN

OTHER OBSERVERS WHO INDEPENDENTLY IDENTIFIED THIS BIRD:

STEVE MAMMOSER, CHRIS WOOD, TONY LEUKERING

OPTICAL EQUIPMENT: BAUSCH & LOMB ELITE 10X42 BINOCULARS, KOWA TSN-824 SCOPE

WEATHER CONDITIONS: SUNNY & BRIGHT

BIRD/SUN ORIENTATION: BIRD IN FRONT, SUN OVERHEAD, SLIGHTLY BEHIND AND TO RIGHT

DISTANCE FROM BIRD AND HOW MEASURED: APPROXIMATED AT 35-40 FEET

NUMBER OF BIRDS SEEN: 1 SEX: FEMALE PLUMAGE:

BEHAVIOR AND DEMEANOR: THE BIRD WAS HOVERING AND FEEDING AT A TRUMPET VINE PLANT. IT WOULD FEED FOR A COUPLE OF MINUTES THEN WOULD GO BACK TO A HIDDEN ROOST EITHER IN THE TREE JUST TO THE WEST OF THE TRUMPET VINE OR WITHIN THE LARGER BUSH BORDERING THE BACK OF THE TRUMPET VINE. AT TIMES SHE WOULD ALIGHT ON FLOWERS AND SMALL TWIG TIPS WHILE FEEDING, GIVING US VERY DECENT VIEWS THROUGH THE SCOPE HEAD & NECK (forehead, crown, auricular & malar regions, median line, etc.): THE CROWN WAS A METALLIC GREEN, THE SAME SHADE AS THE BACK. THE FOREHEAD APPEARED TO BE THE SAME SHADE OF GREEN AS THE CROWN.

EYES & LORES (supercilium, eye-ring, eye-stripe, color, etc.): THE EYES WERE DARK. THE FACE WAS RELATIVELY DARK ABOVE THE EYE AND WHITISH BELOW WITH VIRTUALLY NO OTHER PATTERN.

LOWER & UPPER MANDIBLES (color & shape): THE BILL WAS ALL BLACK, MODERATE IN LENGTH (IN BETWEEN THE LENGTH OF CALLIOPE AND BROAD TAILED)

LEGS & FEET: BLACK

UPPERPARTS (nape, back, rump, uppertail coverts, etc.): THE ENTIRE UPPERPARTS FROM THE HEAD (SEE HEAD & NECK SECTION) TO THE TAIL WAS A METALLIC GREEN, INCLUDING THE FOREHEAD

UNDERPARTS (chin, throat, belly, sides, flanks, crissum, etc.): WHITISH WITH VERY FAINT SPOTTING ON THROAT. THE FLANKS WERE GRAYISH WITH JUST A VERY FAINT BUFF TOWARDS THE BASE OF THE TAIL.

RETRICES (inner, middle & outer tail feathers; color, pattern, shape, etc.):
SEE "DESCRIPTION OF TAIL" ON ATTACHED SHEET

WINGS (color, length, shape, bars, coverts, etc.): THE WINGS WERE
BLACKISH. SEE "DESCRIPTION OF WINGS" ON ATTACHED SHEET

VOCALIZATION (call/song, method of delivery, i.e., from perch, in flight):
NONE.

HABITAT: BAUSHY RIPARIAN NEIGHBORHOOD AREA WITH TALL DECIDUOUS TREES
PLANTED YARDS AND BAUSHY EDGES.

ELIMINATION OF SIMILARLY APPEARING SPECIES:

THE LACK OF BROWN IN THE TAIL ELIMINATES RUFOUS, ALLENS AND BROAD-
TAILED HUMMINGBIRDS. THE LONGER TAIL ELIMINATES CALLIOPE. THE
METALLIC GREEN CROWN TENDS TO ELIMINATE BLACK CHINNED. THE
APPARENT NOTCH IN THE WING TIP ALSO ELIMINATES BLACK CHINNED. THE
BIRD WAS JUST VERY SLIGHTLY BIGGER THAN THE FEMALE CALLIOPE THAT ALSO
WAS THERE. THIS ELIMINATES THE LARGER HUMMINGBIRDS SUCH AS
BLUE THROATED AND MAGNIFICENT. THE BLACK TIP TO RETRICE 3 TENDS TO
ELIMINATE COSTAS AS DOES THE NARROWER PRIMARIES.

PRIOR EXPERIENCE WITH THIS AND SIMILARLY APPEARING SPECIES:

I HAVE SEEN HUNDREDS OF RUBY-THROATED HUMMINGBIRD, HAVING GROWN UP
IN ILLINOIS. I HAVE SEE THOUSANDS OF BROAD TAILED HUMMINGBIRDS,
HAVING LIVED IN COLORADO FOR 29 YEARS. I HAVE EXPERIENCE WITH
DOZENS OF BLACK CHINNED HUMMINGBIRDS FROM NEW MEXICO, ARIZONA,
SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA AND WESTERN COLORADO. I HAVE SEEN
NUMEROUS CALLIOPE HUMMINGBIRDS, AS WELL AS ALL OF THE NORMAL
HUMMINGBIRDS OF ARIZONA AND CALIFORNIA.

BOOKS, ILLUSTRATIONS AND ADVICE CONSULTED THAT INFLUENCED THIS REPORT:
NATIONAL GEOGRAPHIC BIRDS OF NORTH AMERICA

THIS REPORT WRITTEN FROM NOTES MADE DURING ☒ AFTER ☐ OBSERVATION; ☐ FROM MEMORY

NAME: JOE MAMMOSE SIGNATURE: JOE MAMMOSE DATE: 8/2/03

RUBY THROATED HUMMINGBIRD - RARE BIRD RECORD

8/1/03

DESCRIPTION OF TAIL

THE CENTER TWO RETRICES WERE ENTIRELY ^{METALLIC} GREEN, THE SAME COLOR AS THE BACK AND RUMP. THEY WERE ALSO THE SHORTEST FEATHERS IN THE TAIL. RETRICES 2 AND 3 ON EACH SIDE HAD METALLIC GREEN AT THE BASE AND WERE TIPPED BLACK. THE BLACK TIP STRETCHED UP THE TAIL APPROXIMATELY EQUAL TO THE WIDTH OF THE FEATHER. THESE TWO RETRICES WERE LONGER THAN THE CENTER TWO. RETRICES 4 AND 5 ON EACH SIDE HAD METALLIC GREEN AT THE BASE. NEXT TO THIS WAS A BLACK SUB-TERMINAL BAR AND EACH WAS THEN TIPPED WITH WHITE. RETRICE 4 WAS SLIGHTLY LONGER THAN RETRICES 2 AND 3. RETRICE 5 WAS APPROXIMATELY THE SAME LENGTH AS RETRICE 4.

THERE WAS NO BROWN OR RUST COLOR IN THE TAIL. WITH THE CENTER RETRICES BEING SHORTER THAN THE OUTER ONES, THIS GAVE THE TAIL SOMEWHAT OF A CUPPED APPEARANCE WHEN THE BIRD WOULD FLARE ITS TAIL. ALSO, AT REST, THE TAIL WAS LONGER THAN THE WING TIPS.

DESCRIPTION OF WINGS

WHILE THE BIRD SAT ON SOME OF THE TRUMPET FLOWERS AND A TWIG TIP, WE GOT VERY GOOD LOOKS AT THE WINGS. THE PRIMARIES WERE NARROWER THAN WHAT WOULD BE SEEN ON A BROAD TAILED HUMMINGBIRD. EACH PRIMARY TIP HAD SOMEWHAT OF A POINT TO IT. IN ONE GOOD LOOK AT THE WING AT REST, THERE APPEARED TO BE SOMEWHAT OF A SHALLOW NOTCH TO THE WING TIP, INDICATING THAT P-10 AT LEAST WAS NARROWER THAN THE INNER PRIMARIES.